

PFMEA - IATF 16949:2016 Clause Mapping

Audit-Ready Reference | Quality Head Agents

Clause 8.5.1.1 - Control Plan

Control Plans must be driven by the PFMEA. Every high-severity item and special characteristic in the PFMEA must appear in the Control Plan with appropriate detection methods and reaction plans.

Clause 8.5.6.1 - Change Control

When a design or process change occurs, the PFMEA must be updated within a defined timeframe before implementing the change. This is a common Major NC finding during IATF audits.

Clause 8.6.2 - Layout Inspection

Annual revalidation requirements: the PFMEA must be reviewed during annual product layout inspection. Any new failure modes identified must be incorporated.

Clause 8.7.1 - Nonconforming Outputs

Customer complaints and internal NCs must be fed back into the PFMEA to update occurrence ratings, controls, and action priorities. Evidence of this feedback loop is required.

Clause 4.4.1 - Process Approach

PFMEA is the primary tool for demonstrating risk-based thinking (Clause 6.1.2) applied to manufacturing processes. Auditors will assess whether risks have been identified, evaluated, and controlled.

Common Audit Questions

1. Show me the PFMEA for this process step. 2. How was the AP rating for this failure mode determined? 3. What evidence shows High AP items were actioned? 4. How is PFMEA updated when process changes occur? 5. Show the linkage between PFMEA and Control Plan.